

DIHWorld Audio

Dynamics Guard Manual

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Purpose

Dynamics Guard controls entry, impact, sustain, pressure, and containment without hiding the source. Primary family: ANUBIS, OTIS, DEBO, and LOOKOUT. DRUMKRUSHGLUE is the documented support processor for drum-bus pressure and glue.

Fast signal map

Main audio → protected input → detector and dynamics stage → mix → output containment. ANUBIS adds a named stereo Sidechain input. The sidechain controls detection or reduction only; it is never mixed into the audible output.

ANUBIS: gate, key, duck, and sidechain

ANUBIS is a gate/expander with Threshold, Ratio, Range, Attack, Hold, Release, Input, Mix, Output, Sidechain Key, and Sidechain Duck.

- Threshold: detector level that opens passage.
- Ratio: strength of attenuation below threshold.
- Range: deepest allowed attenuation; 0 dB means no gate or duck depth.
- Attack: how quickly passage opens or ducking engages.
- Hold: how long an opened gate remains open.
- Release: how smoothly gain returns or closes.
- Mix: blends the protected dry source with processed output.
- Sidechain Key: external audio drives gate detection only.
- Sidechain Duck: external audio drives a separate reduction envelope.

Four operating states

Key	Duck	Result
Off	Off	Main input drives gate; no ducking.
On	Off	Sidechain drives gate; no ducking.
Off	On	Main input drives gate; sidechain ducks output.
On	On	Sidechain drives gate and separate ducking.

If Key is requested but no sidechain bus is available, ANUBIS safely returns gate detection to the main input. If Duck is requested without a routed sidechain, duck reduction remains inactive. The sidechain itself never reaches the output.

Kick-key setup in Logic Pro

1. Insert ANUBIS on the target bass, music, pad, or effect return.
2. Choose the kick channel in Logic's Side Chain selector.
3. Enable KEY when the kick should open or control the gate detector.
4. Enable DUCK when each kick should reduce the target.

5. Lower Threshold until the key is detected reliably.
6. Set Range for the maximum attenuation; avoid full closure unless intentional.
7. Use fast Attack, short Hold, and tempo-aware Release as a starting point.
8. Bypass-match with Mix and Output before committing.

KEY does not mean ducking. DUCK does not replace KEY. They are independent and may be combined.

Wave and meter reading

- Gold/yellow: coherent centered energy and generally mono-safe passage.
- Purple: stereo spread or phase width; verify in mono.
- Red: anti-phase or threshold-danger behavior; reduce intensity or repair routing.
- IN: main detector energy.
- GATE: current passage state and attenuation.
- KEY: sidechain activity when routed.

OTIS: 3–6–9 dynamics

OTIS separates time scale instead of using one compressor envelope. Micro Peak handles short events and edge control. Meso Density shapes body and phrase density. Macro Level governs long-envelope movement. Makeup Gain changes output level; Gain Match should be used for fair bypass comparison. Raise one time scale at a time and re-check transients after Macro changes.

DEBO: pressure and controlled density

DEBO is pressure-activated dynamics and tone shaping. Drive increases excitation, Maximize raises controlled density, Depth restores weight, and Clarity balances the upper field. Flower of Life adds harmonic-field dispersal. Gain Match supports level-fair auditioning. VOCAL HOLD is the tonal reference preset. Stronger presets are effect stages, not automatic mastering targets; reduce Drive or Maximize first if a vocal becomes hard.

LOOKOUT: transient and sustain

LOOKOUT separates Attack and Sustain, each with a ± 18 dB working range, then passes the result through DIH tone color and containment. The Eye of Heru provides live transient/sustain guidance; it is advisory, not automatic gain riding. Use Attack for front-edge definition and Sustain for body, ring, or room tail.

DRUMKRUSHGLUE: support processor

DRUMKRUSHGLUE is the Dynamics Guard support option for drum buses and parallel lanes. Krush shapes impact and color, Weight controls body, Glue controls cohesion, and Ceiling contains the result. Start on a parallel bus when the desired sound is aggressive; blend beneath the clean drums and bypass-match.

Practical routing

- Kick controls bass: ANUBIS on bass; kick routed to Sidechain; DUCK on; KEY optional.
- Vocal opens ambience: ANUBIS on reverb return; vocal routed to Sidechain; KEY on; DUCK off.
- Vocal clears music: ANUBIS on music bus; vocal routed to Sidechain; DUCK on; KEY optional.
- Drum control: LOOKOUT on source, OTIS on group, DEBO or DRUMKRUSHGLUE in parallel.
- Safety chain: dynamics processor → LOOKOUT observation/shaping → SESHAT final observation.

Use no more than three active processors per track or bus unless a deliberate sound design requires more. SESHAT may remain last as observation only.

Troubleshooting

- No Side Chain selector: fully quit Logic, confirm the current ANUBIS Audio Unit is installed, refresh the Audio Unit registry, then rescan.
- KEY shows no activity: confirm the selected sidechain channel is playing and not muted before its send.
- DUCK does nothing: confirm DUCK is enabled, a sidechain is routed, Range is below 0 dB, and the key has level.
- Gate chatters: increase Hold or Release, soften Ratio, or reduce Range.
- Pumping is excessive: lengthen Release, reduce Range, or disable DUCK and use KEY only.
- Output seems better only because louder: enable Gain Match where available and compare at equal level.
- Vocal turns harsh: reduce DEBO Drive/Maximize, OTIS Micro Peak, or stacked color stages before lowering the final output.

Final check

Confirm routing, bypass-match, listen in context, check mono, and verify no clipping, static, harshness, or unintended level loss. Presets are starting points; protected controls are not loudness theater.